Answers and talk notes

Write and Evaluate Algebraic Expressions

What your student is learning

Tonight we take an algebraic expression, put a number in for the letter, and find its value.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **A.** 5 × y. 5y means 5 × y. A number written next to a letter is multiplication.
2. **C.** 4 × 3. Write 4 × 3. Put 3 in place of k and multiply, so 4k = 12.
3. **B.** 13. x + 8 = 5 + 8 = 13 when x = 5.
4. **D.** 18. 3m = 3 × 6 = 18 when m = 6.
5. **A.** 13. 2n + 5 = 2 × 4 + 5 = 8 + 5 = 13 when n = 4.
6. **C.** 8. 20 − 3w = 20 − 3 × 4 = 20 − 12 = 8 when w = 4.

Talk about it

What did you put in place of the letter, and what did you do first after that?

Home mission

Put 6 coins in each of 4 cups. Take away 9 coins. Ask your student to say 6b − 9 with b = 4, then count the coins left to check.

When they are stuck, ask

- What number goes in for the letter?
- Can you rewrite the whole expression with the number in it?
- Now which operation comes first?

Try not to say

- 6b means 6 plus b.
- Calculate as you go, no need to rewrite.
- "9 less than x" means 9 − x.